THE LABOR PATH TO UNIVERSAL CHILD CARE

The United Federation of Teachers
52 Broadway, 19th Floor
October 20, 2026
8:30AM to 4:30PM

Digital Packet
Storytelling is Universal Sign-Up Form
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Evaluation

Program

8:30AM	**Doors/Breakfast**		
9:00AM to 10:00AM	**Solidarity in Care: Child Care as a Core Labor Issue**	This panel brings together union leadership to discuss why child care is a foundational labor issue for the modern workforce and why the time to act is now.	Opening Remarks: **Marco A. Carrión**, President Consortium for Worker Education Panelists: **Stuart Appelbaum**, President Retail, Wholesale and Department Store Union **Henry Garrido**, Executive Director District Council 37 **Brendan Griffith**, President New York City Central Labor Council **Rich Maroko**, President Hotel & Gaming Trades Council **Michael Mulgrew**, President United Federation of Teachers Moderator: **Janella Hinds,** New York City Central Labor Council & New York Union Child Care Coalition

10:15AM to 11:15AM	**From Policy to Practice: Navigating the National, State, and Local Child Care Landscape**	A deep dive into the national, state, and city child care landscapes—focusing on the urgent need for sustainable public funding, thriving wages, and coverage for non-traditional hours.	Panelists: **Monae Archibeque**, Political Director OLÉ New Mexico **Andrew Hevesi,** Assemblymember Chair of & Committee on Children & Families **Dede Hill,** Vice President of Policy Schuyler Center for Analysis and Advocacy **Andrew Perry**, Director of Fiscal Research Fiscal Policy Institute Moderator:**Tammie Miller,** United Federation of Teachers
11:30AM to 12:30PM	**Valuing the Workforce: Fixing Child Care Compensation in New York**	Child care providers are the lynchpin of universal child care, yet low wages and burnout threaten the entire system. This panel focuses on concrete policy and funding solutions—including salary scales, career ladders, and retention polcies—to lift wages and stabilize the workforce across New York City and New York State.	Panelists: **Dona Anderson**, Executive Director NY Early Childhood Professional Development Institute **Moira Dolan,** Director DC 37 Child Care Trust Fund **Tammie Miller**, Chair of the Family Child Care Providers Chapter United Federation of Teachers **Sanjay Pinto**, Fellow CUNY SLU and Worker Institute at Cornell Moderator: **Ben Parisi,** The Action Lab
12:30PM-1:30PM	**Lunch**		
1:30PM to 2:45PM	**Collective Bargaining & Labor-Driven Child Care Innovations**	Child care is a workplace issue—and a union issue. Hear directly from labor leaders who fought for and won employer-paid child care funds,	Panelists: **Rossmery Dais,** Executive Director 1199SEIU Child Care Funds

		child care centers, and other innovations to support working parents.	**Moira Dolan,** Dirtecor DC 37 Child Care Trust Fund **Doug Friedlander**, Project Lead NYC Childcare Navigator (an initiative of the United Federation of Teachers) **Samantha Klein,** General Organizer Hotel & Gaming Trades Council **Shayna Leigh**, Director of Childcare Programming Workforce Development Institute **Dolores McCullough-Sacaridiz**, Director Bellevue Day Care Center, Inc. **Santos Rodriguez**, Chief of Staff The Building & Construction Trades Council of Greater New York & Vicinity (NYC BCTC) NYS Building Trades Moderator: **Patricia Campos Medina,** The Worker Institute Labor and Unions & Extension Faculty, ILR
3:00PM to 4:30PM	**Building Consensus towards the Labor Vision**	We don't just want a seat at the table—we are setting the agenda. Join interactive breakout groups to help forge a bold, unified vision for universal child care across New York. Together, we will draft strategic priorities and start setting the stage for the 2027 New York State legislative session.	Moderators: **Janella Hinds,** *Secretary-Treasurer* New York City Central Labor Council & New York Union Child Care Coalition **Tammie Miller**, Chair of the Family Child Care Providers Chapter United Federation of Teachers **Arianna Drakotos Schindle,** The Worker Institute Labor and Unions & Extension Faculty, ILR

Speaker Bios



Stuart Appelbaum

President

Retail, Wholesale and Department Store Union (RWDSU)

Stuart Appelbaum entered the labor movement believing that the best way to fight injustice is by organizing people for change. Since becoming President of the Retail, Wholesale and Department Store Union (RWDSU) in 1998, he has been a leading voice for working people, strengthening their collective power and improving the lives of thousands of workers across the country.

Under his leadership, the RWDSU has pioneered new approaches to organizing and secured landmark contracts that have raised standards for wages, benefits, scheduling, and workplace protections. From retail workers to car wash employees, Appelbaum has helped bring a union voice to workers in industries where organizing was once considered out of reach. He also led the union through the nationally recognized 2010 Mott's strike and helped secure landmark living wage legislation in New York City.
An outspoken critic of corporate practices that undermine workers' rights, Appelbaum has challenged major employers, including Walmart and Amazon, and championed workers' right to organize in the face of powerful corporate opposition.

His commitment to building worker power extends globally. As Global President of UNI Commerce and Chair of the UNI Amazon Global Union Alliance, he has helped unite unions across national borders to confront multinational corporations and advance workers' rights, guided by the belief that when corporations operate globally, workers must organize globally as well.

Appelbaum has also strengthened labor's alliances with civil rights, immigrant rights, LGBTQ+ and faith-based organizations, recognizing that the fight for economic justice extends beyond the workplace. Throughout his career, Appelbaum has worked to build a labor movement unafraid to challenge powerful interests, organize where others have said it couldn't be done, and bring working people together to fight for a more just and equitable society.

Appelbaum is a graduate of Brandeis University and Harvard Law School and a member of the Connecticut State Bar. He resides in New York City with his husband.

Website: rwdsu.org



Dona Anderson

Executive Director

NY Early Childhood Professional Development Institute

Dona Anderson is the Executive Director at the New York Early Childhood Professional Development Institute, which is housed at the City University of New York. She leads the work of a dynamic, intelligent, and passionate team dedicated to building essential systems and services to ensure a highly effective early childhood workforce for New York so that all young children and their families have access to excellence. She is responsible for strategic planning, fund development, project growth, and all aspects of the successful management and leadership of the Institute and leads the organizational culture of inclusivity, diversity, teamwork, flexibility, responsiveness, and collaboration

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Monae Archibeque

Political Director

OLÉ New Mexico

Monae Archibeque (she/her) is Political Director at OLÉ New Mexico (Organizers in the Land of Enchantment), a grassroots member organization building independent political power for working families since 2009. Monae builds relationships with members and policymakers to strengthen collective action for worker justice.
Building on New Mexico's constitutional amendment making childcare a right for all New Mexicans and the universal childcare program making it free for all families, Monae works in coalition with early educators, parents, policymakers, and advocates to ensure funding is tied to pay transparency—because these policies only work when ECE workers earn living wages. She guides member-led campaigns connecting electoral power to care worker organizing.

Monae believes democracy is not a spectator sport. Before joining OLÉ, she was a reproductive justice advocate, helping pass the Crown Act, the New Mexico Voting Rights Act, and the Reproductive and Gender-Affirming Health Care Freedom Act. Her work focuses on local elections and building lasting power so working families and care workers across New Mexico have a real seat at the table.

Website: olenm.org



Patricia Campos-Medina

Executive Director

Worker Institute at the School of Industrial and Labor Relations at Cornell University

Dr. Campos-Medina is a researcher, Faculty and labor educator focusing on the intersection of race, immigration status and worker's rights. She is the Executive Director of the Worker Institute at the School of Industrial and Labor Relations at Cornell University where she leads research, policy innovation and training to advance worker justice, collective bargaining rights and the interest of workers in today's economy and society.

Website



Marco A. Carrión

President

Consortium for Worker Education

Marco A. Carrión became President of the Consortium for Worker Education (CWE) last year, bringing a renewed vision to the workforce development arm of the NYC Central Labor Council. He brings decades of leadership experience across the labor, government, and non-profit sectors. He previously served as Executive Director of El Puente, Commissioner of Community Affairs under Mayor Bill de Blasio, and Political Director of the NYC Central Labor Council. He has also served in the political department of the United Federation of Teachers and as Chief of Staff to State Senator Gustavo Rivera. Throughout his career, Carrion has championed economic opportunity, worker empowerment, and community-led solutions.

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Rossmery Dais

Executive Director

1199SEIU Child Care Funds and Corporation

Rossmery Dais is the Executive Director of the 1199SEIU Child Care Funds (CCF) and President of the 1199SEIU Child Care Corporation (CCC), one of the nation's premier labor-management partnerships supporting working families. Bringing more than 20 years of nonprofit experience, she leads programs providing affordable, high-quality child care, education, youth development, and scholarships to over 20,000 families annually in partnership with 500 participating employers.

Since joining CCF and CCC in 2008, Ms. Dais has held numerous leadership roles—including Deputy Executive Director and Chief of Staff—overseeing strategy, operations, and benefit budgets. Her earlier career includes directing youth health-career initiatives at MSIAHEC and providing foster care prevention counseling in the Bronx.

Dedicated to expanding child care access, she serves on the NY Marshall Plan for Moms Task Force and Senator Gillibrand's Child Care Working Group. Ms. Dais holds an MPA from NYU and a BS from Cornell University.

	LinkedIn: Rossmery Dais, MPA Website: 1199seiubenefits.org/childcare Socials: @1199seiuchildcare
	**Moira Dolan** *Director* *DC 37 Child Care Trust Fund* I spent more than 30 years as a negotiator in the Research & Negotiations Department, and a representative to the NY Union Child Care Coalition. In the CUNY Murphy Center program my capstone project was a comparison of union negotiated child care benefits in six unions. This, along with member priorities, led to the inclusion of a child care benefit for DC 37 members in our most recent collective bargaining agreement. As the Director of the Fund, it is my pleasure to help parents everyday with partial reimbursement and get them engaged in the union. Email: childcareinfo@dc37.net Website: dc37.net Socials: @dc37nyc
	**Arianna Drakotos Schindle** *Director of Training* *Cornell Worker Institute* Arianna (she/they/ella/elle) is the Director of Training in Worker Rights and Equity at the Cornell Worker Institute. She has worked extensively on addressing issues of equity within the labor movement, developing programs to address harassment and discrimination for diverse trades and cohorts. As the lead of the Worker Power Hub, Arianna focuses on training and strategy to empower precarious workers, those in the care economy, and affiliated unions—building leadership, strengthening movements, and expanding vision. She coordinates peer-based initiatives including We Rise, a peer training and organizing program designed to transform the domestic worker industry, and Care Forward, a local standards-raising initiative. Her decade of experience as a leader organizer, and education director in labor integrates with her work as a therapist/healer to support the regenerative organizing model —building sustainable movements from the inside out. Arianna also spent over 10 years working in international human rights with communities resisting authoritarianism, and co-founded the Rhiza Collective, an organization focused on storytelling, healing, and organizing for social transformation.



Doug Friedlander

Project Lead

NYC Childcare Navigator (an initiative of the United Federation of Teachers)

Whether it be at a software start-up, serving as a public school educator (high school science), starting and/or running several non-profits, driving community and economic development, or in my current position leading several key projects primarily related to family childcare providers, I enjoy nothing more than partnering with others to eliminate unnecessary suffering so that individuals, organizations, and communities can reach their full potential.

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Henry A. Garrido

Executive Director

District Council 37

Henry A. Garrido is the executive director of District Council 37, New York City's largest public employee union, representing 150,000 members and 89,000 retirees. On Nov. 26, 2024, Garrido was reelected to a fourth term effective January 2025.

Since becoming executive director in 2015, Garrido has focused on encouraging greater member participation, initiating the DC 37 Union Strong organizing campaign. The campaign has led to the highest union membership in DC 37's 80 year history

Garrido previously served as the union's associate director. In that position, he helped establish the Municipal Employees Housing Program, which coordinates grants for first-time homebuyers and provides foreclosure prevention services, financial education and counseling. He also directed the union's white paper project that addressed government waste by investigating the privatization of City services and identifying additional revenue sources. Garrido was also involved in a sustainability initiative focused on increasing green jobs in New York State.

Garrido is an international vice president of the American Federation of State, County and Municipal Employees (AFSCME), co-chair of the Municipal Labor Committee, a trustee on the City of New York's Workforce Investment Board, an advisory board member of the New York City Independent Budget Office, and serves on the board of the New York City Employees Retirement System (NYCERS). Garrido has also served as chair to two Charter Revision Commissions as co-chair of the Racial Justice and the cochair of Commission to Strengthen Local Democracy.

Garrido oversaw the redevelopment of the union's headquarters at 125 Barclay, which reopened as a state-of-the-art member service center during the union's 80th anniversary in 2024. A native of the Dominican Republic, he is the first Latino to head DC 37 since it was formed in 1944.



Dede Hill

Vice President of Policy
Schuyler Center for Analysis and Advocacy

Dede Hill is Vice President of Policy for the Schuyler Center for Analysis and Advocacy, a 154-year old non-partisan, non-profit organization dedicated to advancing policy that strengthens New York families and improves the well-being of all New York children. In this role, Dede coordinates the Schuyler Center's policy team and conducts policy analysis and advocacy in the areas of child care and economic security, oversees child welfare and health policy, and serves as one of many leaders of the Empire State Campaign for Child Care, New York's statewide campaign for universal child care. Prior to joining Schuyler Center, Dede was a Professor of Law at Albany Law School, and practiced law, focusing her scholarship and practice on labor and employment law. She earned a J.D. from University of Wisconsin Law School, and a Bachelor of Arts from Vassar College.

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Janella T. Hinds

Vice President for Academic High Schools
United Federation of Teachers

Secretary-Treasurer
New York City Central Labor Council

Janella T. Hinds brings a wealth of experience in both education and labor to her role as vice president for academic high schools. Now in her fifth term, Janella champions equity for students and empowerment for educators in each and every New York City high school.

Janella's education advocacy and advancement of the labor movement extends beyond the classroom to public- and private-sector union members across the city. She serves as the liaison to the union's School Secretaries Chapter, and in addition to her responsibilities at the UFT, Janella has been re-elected to serve a fourth four-year term as secretary-treasurer of the New York City Central Labor Council. In that role, she is responsible for fiduciary oversight of this umbrella labor organization, which represents 1.3 million workers in about 400 public- and private-sector unions.

Janella, who is currently teaching social studies at the High School for Public Service in Brooklyn, manages to balance classroom teaching and union work with skill and grace. Janella holds degrees from Princeton University and New York University. She is an active member of Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Incorporated.



Brendan Griffith

President

New York City Central Labor Council, AFL-CIO

Brendan Griffith was elected President of the New York City Central Labor Council, AFL-CIO in July 2025. He joined the NYCCLC in 2009 and had previously been its Chief of Staff since 2011. He is also a proud member of Iron Workers Local 40 and the United University Professions.

Brendan's work has involved coordination of various CLC programs as well as oversight of day to day operations, but some of his most rewarding efforts have been his work on the Annual Workers Memorial Day Commemoration, the Annual Commemoration to the 146 victims of the Triangle Shirtwaist Factory Fire, and the CLC's Annual Labor Day Parade.

He currently serves on the boards of the American Labor Museum – Botto House and the Worker Justice Project. He is on the Advisory Board of the Mount Sinai Selikoff Center for Occupational Health and serves as Vice Chair of the Board of the New York Committee for Occupational Safety & Health. Additionally, Brendan is an Adjunct Instructor at SUNY Empire State College's Harry Van Arsdale Jr. School of Labor Studies.

Brendan completed an apprenticeship with Iron Workers Local 40, is a graduate of the NYS AFL-CIO/Cornell Union Leadership Institute and is also a graduate of Fordham University where he majored in Political Science.



Samantha Klein

General Organizer

Hotel and Gaming Trades Council

Samantha Klein is the General Organizer of the Hotel and Gaming Trades Council. Over the course of her 15 years with the union, she has been the lead organizer of over 40 organizing drives and has helped thousands of workers to join the union and win their first union contracts. In addition to supervising the union's external organizing program, Samantha oversees the union's communications, operations, the development of new member services & training programs.



Shayna Leigh

Director of Childcare Programming
Workforce Development Institute

Shayna Leigh resides in the Albany area and has been with WDI since February 2022. She began her career as a Facilitated Enroller, where she gained valuable experience helping individuals and families navigate enrollment into the County CCAP. Shayna currently serves as WDI's Director of Childcare programming.
Shayna is passionate about helping families access resources to support their childcare needs. She takes pride in serving families, building meaningful connections, and contributing to WDI childcare programs helping to make a difference in communities throughout the state.

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Rich Maroko

President
Hotel and Gaming Trades Council, AFL-CIO

Rich is the President of the Hotel and Gaming Trades Council, AFL-CIO, Business Manager of Hotel, Gaming, Restaurant, Club Employees & Bartenders Union, Local 6 UNITE HERE, and the Recording Secretary of UNITE HERE International Union. Throughout his more than 20 years at HTC, Rich has distinguished himself as a fierce negotiator and tireless advocate for workers. He has developed an exceptionally effective strategic approach to fighting for HTC's members. As a result, under his leadership, HTC has achieved the best contracts in its nearly 100-year history, including a new city-wide contract that will increase the pay of New York City housekeepers to over $100,000, passed laws that have a tangible impact the lives of hotel and gaming workers across our region, and pioneered new contract language and benefits for hotel workers, including panic buttons, immigrant's rights, the right to dignity and respect at work and most recently, the creation of new housing and childcare funds.



Dolores McCullough-Sacaridiz

Director
Bellevue Day Care Center

Dr. Dolores has over 30 years experience in the field of Early Childhood Education and has served as director almost 6 years. Dr. Dolores is a Certified Early Childhood Education Teacher (General & Special Education), a Licensed Marriage and Family Therapist and a Licensed Social Worker. Dr. Dolores began her career as a substitute assistant teacher. Over the years, her roles included, but have not been limited to; direct work with children from birth to school age, providing early intervention therapy, teaching candidates for the Child Development Associate (CDA), and leading workshops for education conferences. Her passion for improving the quality of life for children and families guides her commitment to her work.

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	**Tammie Miller** *Chair of the Family Child Care Providers Chapter* *United Federation of Teachers* Tammie Miller is the Chair of the Family Child Care Providers Chapter of the United Federation of Teachers (UFT), representing more than 10,000 home-based providers across New York City. A former private sector professional, Miller opened Safe and Sound Family Child Care in Brooklyn in 2003. To address the systemic challenges facing providers, she helped establish the UFT chapter in 2005 and was elected its first Chairwoman in 2008. Under her leadership, the chapter negotiated its landmark first collective bargaining agreement with New York State. She has secured over $100 million in provider benefits—including dental, vision, quality grants, and $45 million in retroactive pay—along with major regulatory protections regarding city site inspections. Through UFT initiatives, she has also expanded professional development and early literacy training to more than 15,000 providers. Miller holds degrees in speech pathology and political science from Long Island University and is a graduate of Cornell University's ILR program.
	**Michael Mulgrew** *President* *United Federation of Teachers* Michael Mulgrew is the president of the United Federation of Teachers, which represents more than 200,000 public school educators, nurses, and other public service titles and organizations. Mulgrew has consistently used the power of the union and its membership to advocate for the needs of students and their school communities. This has included intensive lobbying to preserve schools' status as safe spaces for all students, protect schools from devastating funding cuts, and help pass historic class size legislation that was decades in the making. A Staten Island native, Mulgrew taught for 12 years at William E. Grady HS in Brooklyn, where he also served as chapter leader. He was reelected to his sixth term as UFT president in the spring of 2025.



Ben Parisi

Director of Strategic Campaign Initiatives
The Action Lab

Ben Parisi is Director of Strategic Campaign Initiatives at The Action Lab, a founding member of Providers Organized for Power (POP), which Ben now coordinates. POP is a statewide coalition of unions, provider associations, base-building groups, policy advocates, and worker organizations campaigning for a universal child care system built on thriving wages for providers. Ben began his career as the organizer of the Child Care for All Campaign at Empower DC in 2009. Before returning to child care through POP, his roles have included managing community grant programs for NYC government, developing USAID humanitarian interventions in Syria, and helping to create a new division for health equity work at the United Way of NYC. Apart from organizing and campaign strategy, his work also draws on a background in program evaluation and learning, data analysis and visualization, and policy research.

Website: popchildcare.org
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Andrew Perry

Director of Fiscal Research
Fiscal Policy Institute

Andrew Perry is Director of Fiscal Research at the Fiscal Policy Institute. In this role, he focuses on tax policy, education and childcare financing, and taxpayer migration. Previously, he held fiscal and economic policy research roles at FPWA, the Citizens Budget Commission, and the New York City Economic Development Corporation. He holds a Master of International Affairs from Columbia University's School of International and Public Affairs.

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Sanjay Pinto

Fellow
CUNY SLU and Worker Institute at Cornell

Sanjay is a sociologist who conducts action-oriented research on the care economy, organizational innovation, and strategies for building worker and community power. In addition to his research affiliations, Sanjay is an advisor to Citizen Share Brooklyn, Co-op Rhody, and the Model Alliance and a member of Solidarity Resource, which develops training tools for advancing a just and democratic economy.

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Santos Rodriguez

Chief of Staff
The Building & Construction Trades Council of Greater New York & Vicinity (NYC BCTC)

Santos Rodriguez is the Chief of Staff for the Building & Construction Trades Council of Greater New York & Vicinity (NYC BCTC), where he drives strategic initiatives, affiliate communication, stakeholder engagement, and lobbying efforts to advance union labor.

Mr. Rodriguez began his career as an apprentice and journeyman with the International Association of Heat & Frost Insulators Local #12. He made history as the youngest full-time officer in the local's history, serving as Organizer and Political Director dedicated to protecting worker safety, fair wages, and benefits. A graduate of The Edward J. Malloy Initiative for Construction Skills (formerly Project Pathways), he continues to champion pre-apprenticeship opportunities as the organization's Community Liaison.

Deeply committed to civic leadership and workforce development, Mr. Rodriguez serves on the NYS Democratic Executive Committee (as At-Large Member and Chair of the Hispanic Caucus), the NYC Mayor's Capital Taskforce, and the NYC EDC Offshore Wind Advisory Council. He also sits on several NYSERDA committees to advance New York's green economy, as well as the boards of SOMOS Inc., Catholic Charities Neighborhood Services, the Workforce Development Institute, and LCLAA. He resides in New York with his wife and two children.

Sponsors

- The **New York City Central Labor Council (NYCCLC)** is a non-profit labor membership organization devoted to supporting, advancing and advocating for the working people of New York City. As the nation's largest regional labor federation, the NYCCLC brings together 300 local unions from every trade, occupation, public and private sector of the New York economy representing more than 1 million workers

- The **Consortium for Worker Education (CWE)** is a New York City based non-profit workforce development organization, overseeing a network of over 40 job training and placement providers across the five boroughs. Rooted in the values of the labor

movement, CWE aspires to empower workers with the skills to thrive, support their families, and strengthen their communities. As the preeminent workforce development organization in New York, CWE will serve as a thought leader, an innovator, and a funder to advance equity and economic mobility for all New Yorkers in the rapidly changing world of work.

- The **New York Union Child Care Coalition (NYUCCC)** began in 1994 as a coalition of 10 unions committed to a child care, work and family agenda. It has since grown and won official recognition from the New York City Central Labor Council. The Coalition has become a forum for unions to share problems and develop cooperative strategies to address mutual concerns regarding work and family issues. The mission of the coalition is to address the urgent need to change the workplace to reflect the reality of the needs of today's working families and to provide a vehicle that will encourage, motivate, and promote increased activism around these vital issues. The multi-year agenda of the coalition is to (1) link individual union efforts to a broader New York City / New York State inter union child care agenda, (2) expand funding and services for quality child care, (3) make the labor movement a leader in addressing work and family issues.

- **The United Federation of Teachers** (UFT) represents nearly 200,000 educators, family childcare providers, nurses, and other professionals committed to strengthening New York City's children, families, and communities. As the only union representing New York City's family childcare providers, the UFT brings a unique perspective to the intersection of labor, early childhood education, and the care economy. The union has fought to improve compensation, benefits, professional development, working conditions, and protections for the early childhood workforce. The UFT believes that expanding access for families cannot come at the expense of the people who provide the care. A truly universal childcare system must be built with the workforce that makes it possible and must be affordable for families, sustainable for providers and educators, and rooted in dignity, professional recognition, and economic security.

- **The Worker Institute at ILR-Cornell** is the labor research education and training center for NY State unions and American workers engaging in research and

education on contemporary labor issues, to generate innovative thinking and solutions to problems related to work, economy and society. The institute brings together researchers, educators and students with practitioners in labor, business and policymaking to confront growing economic and social inequalities, in the interests of working people and their families. A core value of the Worker Institute is that collective representation and workers' rights are vital to a fair economy, robust democracy and just society.

- **Providers Organized for Power (POP)** is a statewide coalition of child care providers, parents, labor unions, and grassroots organizations fighting for universal child care and thriving wages in New York. Founded in 2025 and incubated at The Action Lab, POP builds provider-led power through field campaigns, organizer training, and community-labor partnerships. Notable achievements include establishing a co-governance table with the NYC Mayor's Office, designing an emergency microgrant program for family child care providers, and leading a statewide campaign for child care pay justice.